

DECEMBER

DECEMBER 3

President Lincoln makes his State of the Union address to Congress. His central message is that "the Union must be preserved."

DECEMBER 26

Lincoln's administration agrees to release the Confederate envoys arrested on the *Trent* and offer a partial apology to Britain. This ends the threatened confrontation between Britain and the Union.



The *Trent* Affair

DECEMBER 26

Pro-Union Creek Indians retreat toward Kansas after being defeated in clashes with Confederates in the Indian Territory.